ALBERTA DISTANCE LEARNING CENTRE

SSN2171: PERSONAL PSYCHOLOGY 20

An Introduction to Psychology

Assignment Booklet 1

KEY

Student's Questions and Comments

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SUMMARY

	Possible Marks	Your Marks
	99	
TOTAL	99	

Teacher's Comments:

Teacher's Signature

Revised December 2008

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Personal Psychology 20
Personal Psychology 20: An Introduction to Psychology
Assignment Booklet 1
Alberta Distance Learning Centre

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4601 - 63 Avenue
Barrhead, Alberta Canada T7N 1P4

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Personal Psychology 20

An Introduction to Psychology

ASSIGNMENT BOOKLET 1

Instructions for Submitting Assignment Booklets

1. Submit Assignment Booklets regularly for correction.

2. **Submit only one Assignment Booklet at one time.** This allows your teacher to provide helpful comments that you can apply to subsequent course work and exams (if applicable).

3. **Check the following** before submitting each Assignment Booklet:

   - ☐ Are all assignments complete?
   - ☐ Have you edited your work to ensure accuracy of information and details?
   - ☐ Have you proofread your work to ensure correct grammar, spelling, and punctuation?
   - ☐ Did you complete the Assignment Booklet cover and attach the correct label?

Postal Mail

Determine sufficient postage by having the envelope weighed at a post office. (Envelopes less than two centimetres thick receive the most economical rate.)

Alternate Methods

Contact your teacher if you require an alternate method for submission of assignments.

Personal Psychology 20

Assignment Booklet 1

Assessment

For successful completion of this course, you must

1. **Complete all questions in each Assignment Booklet to the best of your ability.**
   Incomplete Assignment Booklets will be returned unmarked.

2. **Achieve at least 40% on the final exam.**
   In accordance with Alberta Distance Learning Centre policy, the final exam is worth 50% of the final course mark.

3. **Achieve a final course mark of at least 50%.**

Process

- **Read the course material** before working on the activities in this Assignment Booklet. The *Personal Psychology 20 Student Module Book* contains the information necessary for successful completion of your work.

- **Proceed carefully** through each assignment. Reflect upon your answers and prepare your written responses to communicate your thoughts effectively. Time spent in planning results in better writing.

- **Proofread your work** before submitting it for marking. Check for content, organization, paragraph construction (if applicable), grammar, spelling, and punctuation.

- **If you encounter difficulties or have any questions**, contact your course teacher at Alberta Distance Learning Centre for assistance.

Format

If you choose to **use a word processor** for your written work,

- format your work using an easy-to-read 12-point serif font such as Times New Roman
- include your full name and student file number as a document header
- double-space your final copy
- staple your printed work to this Assignment Booklet

Format

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- Staple your printed work to this Assignment Booklet.

Avoid plagiarism by acknowledging all sources you use. Contact your teacher if you are uncertain how to document sources.

Although you are encouraged to work collaboratively and discuss various aspects of this course with others, **all submitted work must be your own**.

Our Pledge to Students

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Barrhead
4601 - 63 Avenue
Barrhead, Alberta T7N 1P4
Phone 780-674-5333
Toll-free 1-866-774-5333
Fax 780-674-6977

Calgary
341 - 58 Avenue SE
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Phone 403-290-0977
Toll-free 1-866-774-5333, ext. 6200
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Edmonton
300 HSBC Building
10055 - 106 Street
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Phone 780-452-4655
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Lethbridge
6 Palliser Education Centre
3305 - 18 Avenue N
Lethbridge, Alberta T1H 5S1
Phone 403-327-2160
Toll-free 1-866-774-5333, ext. 6300
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Section 1 Lesson 1: An Introduction to Psychology

Assignment 1: Understanding Psychology

1. Pretend you are the director of a large clinic. You need to hire one psychiatrist and one family counsellor. Write **two** newspaper want ads asking for qualified people to send in their résumés. For each ad you must state the position, list three duties relevant to the position, and list the education requirement for the position. You must also tell applicants how they can apply for the position.

Want ad One:

(1) Position: ***psychiatrist – pages 3 and 4***

(3) Duties: ***treat physical and mental ailments***

treat behaviour problems

psychotherapy, testing, teaching, researching, consulting

prescribe medication

(2) Required Education:

medical degree and post graduate degree

(1) Invitation to Apply:

name, address, telephone, contact person

Want ad Two

(1) Position: ***family counselor – page 4***

(3) Duties: ***preventative treatment***

consultation ***short term therapy***

develop outreach programs

vocational counseling

(2) Required Education: ***bachelor degree and post graduate degree in counseling***

(1) Invitation to Apply: ***name, address, telephone, contact person***

(3) 2. What are the main differences between a clinical psychologist and a psychiatrist? Be specific.

The main difference is that a psychiatrist is a medical doctor who can treat physical ailments and prescribe medication. A clinical psychologist's main focus is on people with emotional and behaviour problems. A psychiatrist's main focus is on treating people with abnormal behaviours. – pages 3-4

(2) 3. Have you ever been hypnotized? Have you seen someone hypnotized? If so, briefly describe the experience. If not, would you like to be hypnotized? Why or why not?

Student's personal opinion.

(3) 4. In what way is the unqualified use of hypnosis dangerous?

It can disguise serious problems and delay proper treatment. – page 7

(2) 5. Why cannot very young children or mentally handicapped people be hypnotized?

They are unable to give the hypnotist focused concentration. They must also be willing and cooperative. – page 7

6. Define each of the following and provide your own example for each.

(3) a. overt behaviour

A behaviour that can be observed in the form of a physical response.

Student's own example. – page 12

(3) b. covert behaviour

A behaviour that can be observed in the form of a physical response.

Student's own example. – page 12

(2) 7. What do psychologists study? Provide your own example.

Psychologists study behaviour.

Value 15

Assignment 2: Matching Experiments with the Correct Branch of Psychology

This is a matching exercise. On the line to the left of each description listed in column B, write the name of the branch of psychology from column A that best fits the description. Each branch of psychology may be used more than once.

Column A

abnormal psychology	developmental psychology
behavioural psychology	parapsychology
clinical psychology	physiological psychology
cognitive psychology	social psychology

Column B

1.	***Developmental – page 8 (middle)***	studies how infants learn to crawl
2.	***Physiological – page 9 (middle)***	studies the effects of hormones on mood
3.	***Cognitive – page 8 (top)***	uses computer modelling to test its theories
4.	***Social – page 9 (bottom)***	studies the effects of overcrowding and its relationship to stress
5.	***Clinical – page 6 (bottom)***	the practice of treating clients in a helping environment
6	***Abnormal – page 5***	studies the causes of anxiety attacks
7.	***Cognitive – page 8 (top)***	studies the phenomenon of remembering
8.	***Social – page 9 (bottom)***	studies the reasons people stereotype other races
9.	***Parapsychology – page 8 (bottom)***	studies energy patterns of ghosts
10.	***Behavioural – page 6 (middle)***	studies how monkeys can be trained to use sign language

11. ***Physiological – page 9 (middle)***	studies how nerve impulses travel through the body
12. ***Parapsychology – page 8 (bottom)***	has received much criticism in regard to its scientific value
13. ***Developmental – page 8 (middle)***	measures the physical changes a teenager goes through during puberty
14. ***Clinical – page 6 (bottom)***	uses group therapy to help people with alcohol addictions
15. ***Clinical – page 6 (bottom)*** ***or Abnormal – page 5***	researches ways to treat people with depression

Assignment 3: Psychological Experiments

Use information from the following description to answer questions 1 to 6 that follow:

> Dr. Goldilocks decided to test a few different shampoos to see which cleaned hair better. She bought one expensive shampoo, one cheap shampoo, and one moderately priced shampoo. She also purchased three wigs of the same hair type and soiled them exactly the same way and amount. She measured 10 millilitres of each brand of shampoo and washed each wig with a different shampoo in tepid water (about 40 degrees). She worked in the shampoo for three minutes on each wig and rinsed the hair for two minutes. When the experiment was over she recorded her results. She repeated the procedure two more times.

(2) 1. What is one possible hypothesis for this experiment?

Many possibilities. "All shampoos clean equally well." or , "The expensive shampoo will clean the best." etc

(4) 2. Write in point form the procedure she used, so another person could perform this experiment and obtain the same results.

Purchase three shampoos of varying prices.

Purchase three identical wigs and soil them exactly the same way.

Measure out 10 mL of each shampoo.

Wash each wig with a different shampoo (40 degree water for 3 minutes and rinse for 2 minutes).

Record results.

Repeat experiment two more times.

(2) 3. What is the independent variable in this experiment?

The type/price of shampoo.

(2) 4. What is the dependent variable in this experiment?

The cleanness of the wigs after washing.

(3) 5. List at least three variables that were controlled in this experiment.

Type of wig, amount of shampoo, time shampoo worked in, time of rinsing, water temperature, etc.

(2) 6. What was done to ensure reliability in the experiment?

The experiment was repeated 2 times to insure reliability of results. (Glossary page 137)

(2) 7. Does this experiment have validity? Explain.

Yes, it has validity because you can determine if the hair has been cleaned or not. (Glossary page 138)

8. For this question you are to design your own psychological experiment. It does not have to be complex; it can be very simple. If you are stuck for ideas, you can use any of the following:

- an experiment to test whether a lack of sleep hinders problem-solving ability
- an experiment on whether exercise makes people happy
- an experiment to test if giving rats sugar pills makes them complete a maze faster.

(2) a. What is your hypothesis?

Student's choice but a hypothesis must be a prediction.

(Glossary page 136)

(4) b. Write the procedure you would follow in your experiment.

Dependent on student's choice. Must show thought and some detail.

Results must be recorded and the experiment repeated several times.

(2) c. What is your independent variable?

Dependent on student's choice.

(2) d. What is your dependent variable?

Dependent on student's choice.

(3) e. List at least three variables that you had to control in your experiment.

Dependent on student's choice.

(2) f. Where will your research take place and why?

Dependent on student's choice.

Value 20

Assignment 4: Summary

True or False questions: Read each of the following items and write **T** in the blank if the statement is true and **F** if the statement is false.

T (p.2) 1. Psychology is both a philosophical and scientific pursuit.

F (p.8) 2. Psychological paraprofessionals must have medical degrees.

T (p.2) 3. Psychology includes the study of mental and physical processes that affect behaviour.

T (p.12) 4. You cannot see a covert behaviour happening.

F (p.14) 5. The Canadian Council on Animal Care monitors all animal research that occurs in Canada.

T (p.14) 6. The Canadian Council on Animal Care can affect the amount of research money a university receives from the government.

T (p.13) 7. Empirical evidence is data carefully collected from an experiment.

F (p. 8) 8. Developmental psychology is concerned with how humans developed from the apes.

T (p.4) 9. Psychiatrists can prescribe medication to clients.

T (p.10) 10. A hypothesis predicts the outcome of an experiment.

T (p.13) 11. Statistics can yield different types of results depending on the statistical test used.

T (p.8/12) 12. Cognitive psychology studies covert behaviours.

T (p.8/9) 13. Hoaxes and moneymaking schemes have tarnished the image of parapsychology.

T (p.4) 14. Part of a counsellor's job may be testing clients to find what job would suit them best.

F (p.7) 15. Everyone can be hypnotized.

F (p.5/6) 16. An abnormal behaviour is any behaviour not performed by the majority of people.

F (p.7) 17. The degree to which a person can be hypnotized represents their "hypnosis factor".

T (p.9) 18. Social psychology studies the influence people have on each other.

T (p.12/13) 19. Field studies are considered more ethical than laboratory studies.

F (p.12) 20. Extraneous factors add scientific merit to an experiment.

END OF ASSIGNMENT BOOKLET 1

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